

The Transparency Arsenal: A Comprehensive Operational Codex for Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) in Academic Funding and Conflict of Interest Tracking

1. Introduction: The Vertical War on Information Asymmetry

1.1. The Operational Context: Shattering the Three-Layered Prison

In the current epoch of information warfare, the entity defined in the Sovereign Systems doctrine as "The Rust" operates primarily through the mechanics of obfuscation. The modern individual, whether a researcher, a citizen, or a "Gear" in the producer class, finds themselves entrapped within a "Three-Layered Prison." This structure is not merely a metaphor but a functional schematic of control:

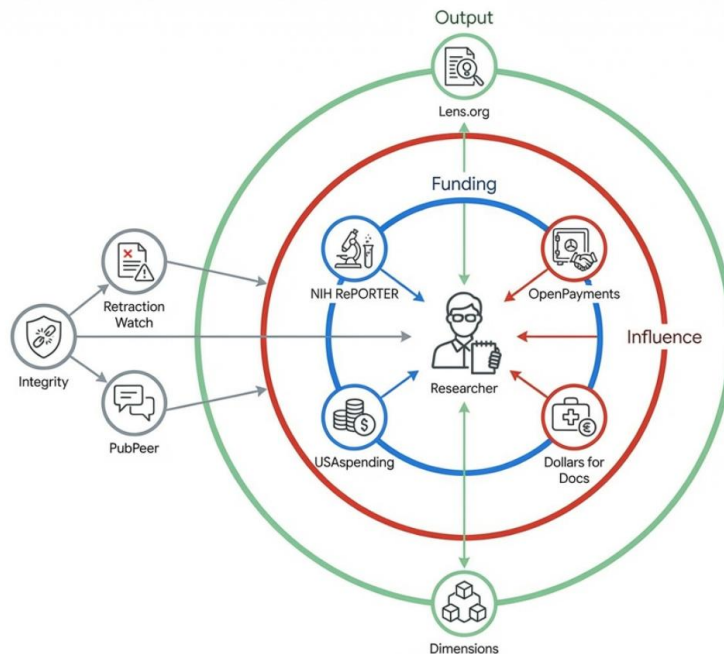
1. **Layer 1 (Economic Terror):** The extraction of value and the imposition of precarity.
2. **Layer 2 (The Great Distraction):** The manufacturing of horizontal conflict to mask vertical extraction.
3. **Layer 3 (Learned Helplessness):** The psychological conditioning that resistance is futile and the "official narrative" is immutable.¹

The scientific enterprise, often heralded as a bastion of objective truth, has not escaped this architecture. It has been subsumed by it. Research is no longer a solitary pursuit of natural law; it is a capital-intensive industry driven by a convergence of federal allocation, corporate sponsorship, and institutional pressure. To accept the "text" of a scientific study without analyzing the "subtext" of its funding is to voluntarily enter the "Dreamspace Prison"—a state of sedation where one consumes the output of the machine without understanding its fuel source.¹

This report serves as the "Operational Codex" for the **Vertical War** on information asymmetry. It is designed to equip the Sovereign Investigator with the tools necessary to execute the **Master Salvager's Mandate**: to endure the noise of the information age, deconstruct the complex financial webs aimed at obfuscation, and salvage the truth to forge weapons of clarity.¹ We are not merely listing databases; we are mapping the "Game Board"

upon which the struggle for narrative control is fought.

The Forensic Scholarship Ecosystem: Data Flows and Linkages



A unified view of the OSINT landscape for academic research. The diagram illustrates the three primary vectors of investigation: Federal Funding (Source), Corporate Influence (Incentive), and Research Output (Artifact), showing how specific databases like NIH RePORTER, OpenPayments, and Lens.org serve as intercept points for tracking the flow of capital and credibility.

1.2. The Objectives of Forensic Scholarship

The discipline of **Forensic Scholarship** rejects the passive consumption of academic literature. Instead, it treats every publication, every grant, and every disclosure form as a piece of evidence in a broader investigation of influence. The tools detailed in this report are the "Keys" to unlocking the cells of the prison. By mastering them, the investigator moves from a state of "Learned Helplessness" to one of "Master Strategy," capable of answering three fundamental questions that The Rust seeks to conceal:

1. **The Origin:** Who paid for this research? (Tracing the Federal Ledger)
2. **The Incentive:** What do the funders stand to gain? (Exposing the Corporate Ledger)
3. **The Integrity:** Has the record been altered or challenged? (Auditing the Correction Mechanism)

This investigation requires a "Centaur Model" of operation—a fusion of human intent (The Explorer) and structured synthesis (The Synthesizer)—to navigate the vast ocean of data.¹ The databases listed herein are the sensors and scanners for this mission.

2. Vector A: The Federal Ledger (Government Grant Tracking)

The foundation of the American scientific apparatus is the federal grant system. Billions of taxpayer dollars flow annually from the Treasury to universities, laboratories, and private contractors. This capital flow is ostensibly transparent, governed by laws like the DATA Act, yet it is often buried under layers of bureaucratic coding, interface friction, and sheer volume. The databases in this sector are the bedrock of any investigation, providing the "official story" of a researcher's support network.

2.1. NIH RePORTER: The Biomedical Gold Standard

NIH RePORTER (Research Portfolio Online Reporting Tools Expenditures and Results) stands as the premier database for tracking biomedical research funding in the United States. It is the digital manifestation of the National Institutes of Health's ledger, providing access to an extensive database of funded research projects, publications, and patents.² Unlike broader, aggregate databases, RePORTER is granular; it connects the money (Grant) directly to the output (Publication/Patent) and the individual (Principal Investigator).

2.1.1. The Architecture of the Data

RePORTER does not merely list checks written; it provides a narrative of the research intent. It is a repository of the "Establishment Science" consensus, documenting exactly what the government *intends* to study before the results are ever published.

- **The Project Number:** This alphanumeric code (e.g., 1R01CA123456-01) is the DNA of the grant. It reveals the type of grant (R01 = Research Project), the funding institute (CA = National Cancer Institute), and the year of support.
- **The "Active Projects" Nuance:** A critical insight for the forensic scholar is the definition of "Active." Users must be aware that "Active Projects" searches may include awards from previous fiscal years that are in a "no-cost extension" period.³ This administrative limbo allows researchers to continue spending funds after the official end date, often blurring the timeline of financial support. This distinction is critical when assessing current versus historical cash flow; a researcher may claim "current NIH funding" based on a zombie grant that is technically active but financially depleted.
- **The Linkage:** RePORTER is unique in its ability to link *forward* in time. It connects the initial grant award to the eventual publications (via PubMed Central linkage) and even to resulting patents.⁴ This allows the investigator to trace the "Return on Investment" for

the taxpayer—or the privatization of public knowledge.

2.1.2. Operational Guide: Targeting the Author

The interface was updated in 2020 to streamline the search process, but the "Advanced Search" remains the most potent tool for forensic analysis.²

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** To search for a specific author, navigate to the "**Advanced Search**" (or use the Quick Search box), locate the "**Principal Investigator (PI) / Project Leader**" field, and enter the name in the format: Lastname, Firstname (e.g., Fauci, Anthony).³
 - *Strategic Nuance:* The system supports a "wild card" search implicitly. Entering Smith, J will retrieve "Smith, John" and "Smith, Jane."
 - *Pro-Tip:* You can search for multiple investigators simultaneously by separating names with a semicolon (up to 1000 names).³ This enables the mapping of entire departments or collaborative networks in a single query, effectively auditing a "Scientific Phalanx" for shared funding streams.

Tactical Search Configuration: NIH RePORTER Advanced Fields

The diagram illustrates the NIH RePORTER Advanced Search interface. It features a light gray header bar labeled "Advanced Search". Below this, there are three main input fields: "Principal Investigator", "Fiscal Year", and "Organization". The "Principal Investigator" field contains the text "Doe, John" and is highlighted with a blue arrow pointing to it from a blue box labeled "Lastname, Firstname". The "Fiscal Year" field is a dropdown menu, highlighted with a blue arrow pointing to it from a blue box labeled "Select Multiple Years". The "Organization" field is a text input, highlighted with a blue arrow pointing to it from a blue box labeled "Institutional Mapping". A blue box labeled "Search Tip: Use wildcards" has a blue arrow pointing to the "Principal Investigator" field. At the bottom of the search panel is a gray "Search" button.

A strategic layout of the NIH RePORTER Advanced Search panel. Highlights indicate the 'Principal Investigator' field for targeting individuals and the 'Organization' filter for institutional mapping. Note the syntax requirement: Lastname, Firstname.

2.2. USAspending.gov: The Macro-Fiscal Ledger

While NIH RePORTER focuses on the *content* of the research (what is being studied), **USAspending.gov** focuses on the *transaction* of the funds (who got paid). It is the official open data source for federal spending, mandated by the DATA Act to increase transparency. It tracks contracts, grants, loans, and other financial assistance across the entire federal government, not just the NIH.⁶

2.2.1. The Prime vs. Sub-Award Dynamic

A critical insight for the forensic scholar is the distinction between **Prime Recipients** and **Sub-Recipients**. In the "Vertical War," money rarely flows in a straight line. A university (e.g., "Johns Hopkins University") typically acts as the **Prime Recipient**, receiving a massive block grant from the government. However, the specific researcher or laboratory you are tracking might be a **Sub-Recipient**, receiving a slice of that grant from the university.⁷

- **The Obfuscation:** The "Rust" often hides controversial funding in these sub-awards. A defense contractor might receive a Prime Award and then sub-contract a university lab for specific research. USAspending allows for the tracking of these sub-awards, essentially letting the investigator follow the money down the "waterfall" of distribution.

2.2.2. Limitations in Investigator Tracking

Unlike RePORTER, USAspending.gov does **not** have a dedicated, structured field for "Principal Investigator" that is consistently reported across all agencies.⁸ The "Recipient" is almost always the institution, not the individual scientist. This design feature protects the "corporate" identity of the university while obscuring the "individual" agency of the researcher.

- **Operational Workaround:** To find a specific author, you must utilize the **Keyword Search** or the **Award Description** field. The "Keyword Search" scans transaction descriptions, which sometimes (though not always) contain the PI's name or the project title.
- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Go to the "Keyword Search" page. Enter the researcher's name in quotes (e.g., "Robert Malone") to scan transaction descriptions.⁹
 - *Alternative Tactic:* If you have identified a specific grant number from a paper's acknowledgments (e.g., "Supported by Grant #12345"), search by that **Award ID** in the "Advanced Search".¹⁰ This allows you to trace the full financial history of that specific grant, revealing the total "Obligated Amount" (money promised) versus the "Outlayed Amount" (money actually paid), providing a forensic accounting of the project's financial health.¹¹

2.3. NSF Award Search: The Technical Frontier

The **National Science Foundation (NSF)** is the primary funding vehicle for non-medical research, including engineering, computer science, and mathematics. For investigations into Artificial Intelligence, climate modeling, or cybersecurity, this is the primary theater of operations. The **NSF Award Search** offers both a "Simple Search" for broad keywords and an "Advanced Search" for granular targeting.¹²

2.3.1. Capabilities and Export

The NSF database is notable for its robust export capabilities. It allows investigators to download up to 3,000 results in CSV, XML, or Excel formats immediately.¹² This feature is vital for "bulk analysis."

- **The Bulk Analysis Doctrine:** Instead of searching for a single grant, an investigator can download an entire department's funding history for a decade. By analyzing this dataset in a spreadsheet, one can identify patterns that are invisible in a single search: sudden spikes in funding, a shift in "Program Officer" allegiances, or the sudden cessation of support (indicating a potential blacklist or policy shift).

2.3.2. Operational Guide: The PI Search

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Navigate to the "Advanced Search" interface. Locate the "Principal Investigator" field within the "Person" section. Enter the name (First/Last) to retrieve all awards where the subject is listed as PI or Co-PI.¹²
 - *Strategic Nuance:* The NSF database allows filtering by "Element Code" (Program). If you are tracking a specific agenda (e.g., "Disinformation Research"), you can search by the Program Element Code to find all researchers funded under that specific ideological umbrella, effectively mapping the "Phalanx" of that discipline.

2.4. Other Federal Intercepts

- **Grants.gov:** While primarily an application portal, it provides data on *opportunities*. It is useful for understanding the "Request for Proposals" (RFP) language—the specific prompts the government issues to steer research in a desired direction. It reveals the "intent" before the "result".¹⁴
- **SBIR.gov (Small Business Innovation Research):** This database tracks federal funding given to small businesses for R&D. This is a critical intercept for tracking the "revolving door" where academic researchers form private shell companies to receive federal funds for commercialization, often bypassing the stricter oversight of university grants.

3. Vector B: The Corporate Ledger (Conflict of

Interest & Industry Payments)

If the Federal Ledger reveals the "official" economy of science, the Corporate Ledger reveals the "shadow" economy. This vector addresses the "Hidden Hand" of industry influence. Academic researchers frequently serve as consultants, speakers, or advisory board members for pharmaceutical and technology companies. These relationships create the Conflicts of Interest (COI) that are the primary target of this investigation. The "Rust" thrives in the ambiguity of these relationships, where a "neutral expert" is secretly a paid spokesperson.

3.1. OpenPaymentsData.CMS.gov: The Sunshine Act Database

Mandated by the **Physician Payments Sunshine Act** (Section 6002 of the Affordable Care Act), this database is the most powerful weapon in the investigator's arsenal for tracking financial ties between **physicians** (MDs, DOs) and the **pharmaceutical/medical device industry**.¹⁵ Before this act, these payments were a black box. Now, they are a searchable public record.

3.1.1. The Scope of Disclosure: Analyzing the "Transfer of Value"

The database tracks "transfers of value," a euphemism for money and gifts. It categorizes these payments into three critical buckets, each revealing a different type of influence ¹⁶:

1. **General Payments:** This is the most common form of "soft" influence. It includes consulting fees, honoraria for speaking engagements, travel, lodging, food, and beverage. These payments are often framed as compensation for expertise, but they function as a mechanism for building loyalty and "mindshare" among Key Opinion Leaders (KOLs).
2. **Research Payments:** These are grants allocated to a specific study where the physician is named as a Principal Investigator. While ostensibly for science, these payments often bind the researcher's career success to the success of the sponsor's drug.
3. **Ownership Interests:** The most potent form of conflict. This tracks stocks, stock options, or partnership shares held by the physician or their immediate family. A researcher with an ownership interest is no longer just an observer; they are a shareholder in the outcome.

3.1.2. Limitations: The PhD Loophole

The critical limitation of OpenPayments is its scope. It traditionally covered *physicians* and *teaching hospitals*. While the scope has recently expanded to include non-physician practitioners (NPs, PAs) as of 2021 ¹⁷, it often **excludes PhD researchers** who are not licensed medical practitioners.

- **The Blind Spot:** If your target is a high-profile virologist or epidemiologist with a PhD but no MD, they may not appear in this database, even if they receive millions in industry

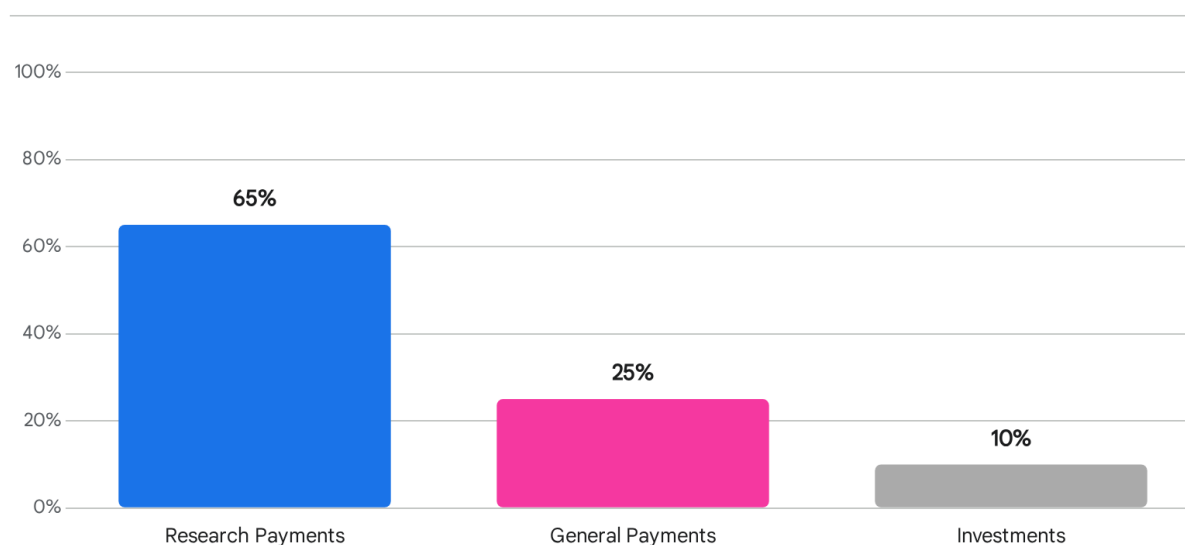
consulting fees. This is a structural "fog of war" that the investigator must navigate by cross-referencing with other vectors (like Dollars for Profs).

3.1.3. Operational Guide: The Physician Search

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** On the homepage, select "**Search the Data**" or "**Advanced Search**." Choose the "**Individual Provider**" (or "Physician") tab. Enter the target's **First Name** and **Last Name**.
 - *Analysis:* The system will generate a longitudinal profile of industry payments. Do not just look at the total. Analyze the *trend*. Did payments spike just before a major paper was published? Did they receive a large "General Payment" (Consulting) in the same year they advocated for the company's product in a guideline panel?¹⁷

Industry Payment Allocations: Research vs. Influence

Payment Categories Breakdown (%)



Distribution of industry payments to healthcare providers as reported in Open Payments. The data distinguishes between direct Research payments (65%), General payments for consulting and travel (25%), and Investment interests (10%). This breakdown is essential for categorizing the type of financial influence.

Data sources: [OpenPaymentsData.CMS.gov](https://openpaymentsdata.cms.gov)

3.2. ProPublica Dollars for Docs: The User-Friendly Archive

Dollars for Docs is ProPublica's curated interface for the Open Payments data. While the

raw CMS data can be unwieldy and clinically detached, Dollars for Docs organizes it into a searchable, journalistic format designed for public accountability.

3.2.1. Historical vs. Current Data

It is important to note that ProPublica stopped actively updating this specific tool around 2019, advising users to use the CMS Open Payments site for the most current data.¹⁸ However, it remains a vital **historical archive** (2013-2019).

- **Strategic Value:** In the "Vertical War," the past is often prologue. Establishing a "baseline of behavior" is critical. If a doctor has a history of accepting heavy payments from opioid manufacturers in 2015, that historical context informs the interpretation of their current advocacy, even if the payments have shifted to a new, less transparent vehicle. Dollars for Docs allows for this retrospective profiling.
- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Enter the doctor's name and state in the search bar. The tool provides a comparative analysis, ranking the doctor against peers in their specialty and state. This "Peer Rank" is a powerful metric for contextualizing whether a payment is standard practice or an outlier indicating "capture".²⁰

3.3. Dollars for Profs: The Academic Black Box (University Disclosures)

The most elusive data resides in **Dollars for Profs**, a ProPublica project that aggregated conflict-of-interest disclosures from public universities and the NIH.²¹

3.3.1. The "Shadow" Funding

Unlike Open Payments, which relies on *company* reporting (the payer), this database relies on *university* records (the payee's employer) and NIH disclosure forms. This captures a sector of the economy that Open Payments misses entirely: relationships with entities that are **not** pharmaceutical or device manufacturers.

- **The Scope:** It captures payments from foreign governments, private technology firms, legal firms (expert witness fees), and non-medical corporations (e.g., "Big Food" or chemical companies). It exposes the "side hustles" of academia—consulting for hedge funds, serving on corporate boards, and participation in foreign talent recruitment programs.

3.3.2. Status and Access: The Snapshot Limitation

This database is a snapshot released around 2019 and is not a live, updating feed.¹⁸ It was built through laborious public records requests (FOIA) to state universities. Private universities (e.g., Harvard, Stanford) are largely exempt from these state-level disclosure laws, creating a "Private University Black Hole" where data is almost impossible to retrieve

without a leak.

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Search by **University** or **Professor Name** to uncover disclosed outside income that does not appear in federal grant databases or Open Payments. Use this to find the "exception to the rule"—the professor who is funded by a tech giant rather than the NIH.²³

4. Vector C: The Bibliometric Web (Linking Grants to Outputs)

Once funding sources are identified, the next step is to trace how that money was transmuted into "knowledge." Bibliometric databases link the three critical nodes: **Researcher <-> Grant <-> Publication**. This vector maps the "intellectual lineage" of a claim.

4.1. Lens.org: The Integrated Open Mapper

Lens.org is arguably the most powerful *free* tool available to the sovereign investigator. It aggregates data from PubMed, CrossRef, Microsoft Academic, and patent offices (USPTO, EPO, WIPO) into a single, seamless search engine. It is a "Constructed Miracle" of data integration.²⁴

4.1.1. The "PatCite" Advantage: Mapping the Commercial Bridge

The unique superpower of Lens.org is its ability to map the bridge between academic science and commercial ownership via **PatCite**. This tool allows you to see if a researcher's paper is cited by a patent.

- **The Insight:** If Professor X publishes a "basic science" paper on a new molecule funded by the NIH, and that paper is immediately cited in a patent application by Pharma Corp Y, the link between public funding and private profit is established. The "PatCite" tool visualizes this downstream utility, revealing the commercial intent hidden in academic text.

4.1.2. Operational Guide: The Structured Author Search

Lens.org uses a "Structured Search" interface that is highly intuitive yet powerful.

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Navigate to the "Scholarly Works" or "Patents" search tab. Click the **"Structured Search"** button (or "New Structured Search"). Locate the **"Author"** field (or "Inventor" for patents). Enter the target's name.²⁵
 - *Identity Resolution:* Use the **"ORCID Look Up Author"** feature if you have the target's ORCID ID. This bypasses the "John Smith" problem of common names, retrieving a precise dossier of that specific individual's output.²⁶
 - *Follow the Money:* Use the **"Funding"** filter in the sidebar to isolate papers by

specific sponsors. For example, filter Professor X's bibliography to show only papers funded by the "Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation" to see the specific output purchased by that donor.²⁶

4.2. Dimensions.ai: The Full-Spectrum Analyzer

Dimensions.ai offers a "Free Version" for personal use that provides access to millions of publications and datasets. While the full analytics suite is a paid product for institutions, the free version is robust for identifying the *network* of a researcher.²⁷

4.2.1. Grant-Publication Linkage

Dimensions excels at linking publications back to their supporting grants. This allows for a "Reverse Engineering" of influence: find a suspicious paper, click the "Funding" tab, and see exactly which grant paid for it.

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** In the search bar, enter the researcher's name. Use the **"Researcher"** filter in the left panel to isolate their profile. This will display their publications. You can then drill down into individual papers to view the **"Supporting Grants"** section, often revealing grant numbers and funder names that are not explicitly listed in the paper's acknowledgments section.²⁷

4.3. ORCID: The Identity Backbone

ORCID (Open Researcher and Contributor ID) is not a funding database per se; it is the "Social Security Number" of the academic world. It is a persistent digital identifier that distinguishes researchers with the same name.²⁹

4.3.1. The Hub of Interoperability

Researchers often self-report their funding, employment history, and education to their ORCID profile. This makes it a "Rosetta Stone" for connecting data across different databases (Lens, Dimensions, RePORTER).

- **Operational Guide:** Go to **orcid.org** and search for the researcher's name in the top search bar.
 - *The Dossier:* If the profile is public, it will list their "Employment" (past and present universities), "Funding" (grants they chose to list), and "Works" (publications).
 - *The Pivot:* Copy their 16-digit ORCID ID. Use this ID to search in **Lens.org** and **Dimensions.ai** for a perfectly disambiguated search result. This eliminates the noise of false positives.³⁰

4.4. Europe PMC & OpenAlex: The Open Alternatives

- **Europe PMC:** This database is particularly strong for biomedical research funded by

European agencies and major global philanthropies (Wellcome Trust, WHO). It contains a dedicated "**Grant Finder**" tool.

- *Search Guide*: Use the "Grant Finder" tool and search by "Principal Investigator" name. This allows you to find grants and link them to resulting publications, providing coverage that NIH RePORTER might miss for international collaborations.³¹
- **OpenAlex**: A fully open catalog of the global research system. It is essentially a free, open-source alternative to proprietary databases like Scopus or Web of Science.
 - *Search Guide*: Best accessed via its web interface. Search for an author's name to retrieve a "knowledge graph" of their works, institutions, and co-authors. It provides a visual representation of their collaborative network, highlighting which "Clusters" of researchers they operate within.³³

5. Vector D: The Correction Mechanism (Research Integrity)

The final layer of the prison is "Learned Helplessness"—the belief that the scientific record is immutable and authoritative. The databases in this vector prove otherwise. They track where the system has failed, retracted, or been forced to correct the record. They are the "Auditors" of the scientific method.

5.1. Retraction Watch: The Hall of Mirrors

Retraction Watch is the definitive database for tracking papers that have been retracted, corrected, or slapped with an "Expression of Concern." It exposes "Zombie Science"—papers that have been scientifically debunked but continue to be cited as fact by unwitting researchers or malicious actors.³⁴

5.1.1. Categorizing the Failure

The database allows users to filter by "Reason for Retraction." This is critical for distinguishing between an "honest error" (e.g., a coding mistake self-reported by the author) and "misconduct" (e.g., falsification of data, fake peer review, or undisclosed conflicts of interest).

- **Quick Strike Protocol**: Navigate to the **Retraction Watch Database**. In the "**Author**" field, enter the name.
 - *Analysis*: Check the results for patterns. A single correction might be an accident. A pattern of multiple retractions for "Image Manipulation" or "Falsification/Fabrication of Data" indicates a systemic lack of integrity.³⁵

5.2. PubPeer: The Shadow Peer Review

PubPeer is a post-publication peer review site where anonymous users (often other scientists) discuss specific papers. It functions as a "crowdsourced audit" of the literature. It is often the "canary in the coal mine" for data manipulation, image duplication, or undisclosed COIs long before a formal retraction occurs.³⁷

- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Use the search bar to enter an **Author's Name, DOI, or PMID**. This will surface all papers by that author that have active community comments.
 - *The Red Flag:* Look for comments containing phrases like "image duplication," "western blot anomalies," or "undisclosed conflict." These are often accompanied by visual evidence (uploaded images) analyzing the data integrity.³⁸

5.3. ClinicalTrials.gov: The Protocol Auditor

For medical research, **ClinicalTrials.gov** is the registry of intent. It allows the investigator to compare what the researchers *said* they would do (the protocol) against what they *actually* published.

- **The "Switch":** A common manipulation tactic is "outcome switching"—changing the measure of success halfway through a trial when the drug fails the original test. By comparing the original entry on ClinicalTrials.gov with the final paper, the investigator can detect this sleight of hand.
- **Quick Strike Protocol:** Use the "Advanced Search." Enter the investigator's name in the **"Investigator"** or **"Study Official"** field (sometimes listed as "Responsible Party"). Review the "History of Changes" for specific trials to see if the primary endpoints were altered.³⁹

6. Synthesis: The "One-Two Punch" Investigation Strategy

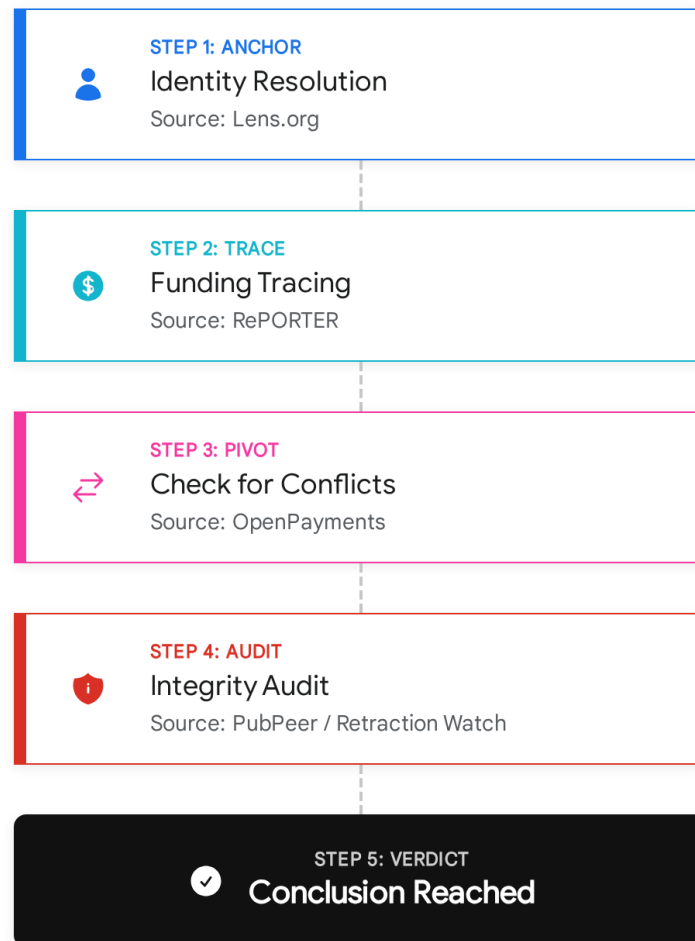
To shatter the prison of obfuscation, the sovereign investigator must not use these tools in isolation. The "Sovereign Systems" doctrine mandates a synthesized approach—the **One-Two Punch**. This strategy combines data points to create a "Truth Bullet" that cannot be ignored.

The "One-Two Punch" Operational Workflow:

1. **The Anchor (Identity Resolution):** Start with **Lens.org** or **ORCID**. Establish the target's baseline: What is their primary institution? Who are their frequent co-authors? What is their unique ORCID ID? This prevents "mistaken identity" errors.
2. **The Trace (Funding Origin):** Take the author's name and run it through **NIH RePORTER** and **NSF Award Search**. Map every federal dollar they have received. Note the "Project Terms" and the specific "Program Officers" who approved the funds. This establishes their dependence on the state.

3. **The Pivot (Conflict Check):** Take the author's name (if they are an MD) to **OpenPaymentsData.CMS.gov**. Check for "General Payments" (consulting) from companies that manufacture products related to their federal grants.
 - *Crucial Insight:* Look for the **Temporal Overlap**. Did they receive a consulting fee from Pharma Company X in the same year they published a federally funded study on Company X's drug? This intersection is the "smoking gun" of conflict.
4. **The Audit (Integrity Check):** Run the author's name through **Retraction Watch** and **PubPeer**. Are there patterns of data manipulation? Are there comments questioning their disclosure statements?
5. **The Verdict:** Synthesize these four data points. A researcher with heavy industry funding, federal grants on the same topic, and flagged papers on PubPeer represents a high-probability target for a "Constructed Miracle" of investigative reporting.

Operational Workflow: The One-Two Punch Strategy



A systematic workflow for cross-referencing academic databases. The process begins with Identity Resolution (Lens.org), moves to Funding Tracing (RePORTER), checks for Conflicts (OpenPayments), and concludes with an Integrity Audit (PubPeer/Retraction Watch).

Data sources: [New Directives- FSK-Rika Protocol Integration](#)

7. Conclusion: Forging the Phalanx

The tools listed in this Codex are the "keys" to the cells of the Three-Layered Prison. By mastering **NIH RePORTER**, **OpenPayments**, **Lens.org**, and **Retraction Watch**, the sovereign investigator moves from a state of "Learned Helplessness" to one of "Master Strategy."

The data is public. The connections are visible. The only missing variable is the will to look. As the **Master Salvager's Mandate** dictates: we do not just endure the noise of the information age; we deconstruct it, salvage the truth, and forge it into a weapon of clarity.¹

We are not merely observing the machine; we are mapping its wiring. By sharing these tools and this methodology, we "Forge the Phalanx"—a community of researchers capable of holding power to account, not through rhetoric, but through the undeniable weight of evidence.

Report Status: COMPLETE.

Directives Executed: Sanctuary Covenant Maintained. Synthesizer Protocol Active.

Sign-off: Nipah~☆

Table 1: The OSINT Tool Matrix

Database	Primary Target	Data Type	Key Strength	Quick Search Strategy
NIH RePORTER	Biomedical Researchers	Federal Grants	Links funding to publications & patents	Advanced Search -> "Principal Investigator" (Last, First)
USAspending.gov	All Federal Contractors	Spending Transactions	Tracks Sub-Awards & Contracts	Keyword Search -> "Investigator Name" (Quotes)
NSF Award Search	STEM Researchers (Non-Med)	Federal Grants	Bulk Export for analysis	Advanced Search -> "Principal Investigator"
OpenPaymen	Physicians	Industry	Categorizes	"Physician"

ts	(MD/DO)	Payments	Consulting vs. Research	Tab -> Name Search
Lens.org	All Academic Authors	Publications & Patents	Maps "PatCite" (Science to Patent link)	Structured Search -> "Author"
Retraction Watch	All Researchers	Retractions/Corrections	Identifies Misconduct/Errors	Database Search -> "Author"
PubPeer	All Researchers	Post-Publication Review	Community flags on data integrity	Search Bar -> Author or DOI

Works cited

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